HSC Business Studies 2016-17
Task 1: Case Study Extended Response (Marking Criteria)

2017 COHORT AVERAGE (essay only): 13.5/20
2017 COHORT AVERAGE (essay & research): 18.3/25
2017 COHORT RANGE: 8-24/25

Question: Evaluate the effectiveness of operations management in improving business performance

Criteria	***Marks***
• Makes a **well-reasoned** judgement, based on criteria, regarding the effectiveness of operations management in improving business performance • **Applies** relevant case study/studies and contemporary business issues • Presents a **sustained, logical and cohesive** response and communicates **clearly** using **relevant** business terminology and concepts	17-20
• Makes judgements regarding the effectiveness of operations management • **Uses** relevant case study/studies and contemporary business issues • Presents a **logical and cohesive** response using **relevant** business terminology and concepts	13-16
• **Provides characteristics and features** of operations management AND/OR makes **some** judgment of the effectiveness of operations management • **May refer** to case study/studies and contemporary business issues • Communicates **using** business terminology and concepts	9-12
• **Sketches in general terms** operations management • **May refer** to case study/studies and contemporary business issues • Communicates using **some** business terminology and concepts	5-8
• **Makes limited reference** to operations management • **May identify** case study/studies • Uses **basic** business terminology	1-4

Answers could include:
'Operations management' may include:

operations processes (any dot points within)
operations strategies (any dot points within)

Measures of effectiveness/business performance:
• profit maximisation (sales/costs); market share; competitive advantage; meeting needs of stakeholders; efficiency & effectiveness; ethical behaviour

Contribution of operations management to business performance:
• strategic role of operations management – cost leadership, good/service differentiation
• performance objectives – quality, speed, dependability, flexibility, customisation, cost
• responsiveness of business to *influences* on operations (challenges/threats and opportunities)
• how well the operations strategies implemented by a business improve performance

[Students may take an alternative approach, which, if correct, should be rewarded.]

MARKERS GENERAL COMMENTS (NTA & SXC)

Better responses:

- Demonstrated an understanding of the syllabus theory/content and used business terminology and concepts to express this understanding
- Integrated specific information and detail about their case study/ies → both about the actual strategies implemented as well as the impact of those strategies (on performance objectives and business performance)
- Established clear criteria to judge the effectiveness of operations management (in terms of operational performance objectives and then also the measures of broader business performance)
- Showed how/why business performance was improved with detail (not just saying "this improved business performance")
- Evaluated 3 or 4 aspects of operations management
- Tended to use more than 1 case study (usually 2 or 3)
- Maintained focus on the question that was set and used the language of the question to frame their response

Weaker responses:

- Lacked detail – either in terms of course theory/content or case study material or both
- Used informal/casual language
- Made sweeping statements about operations and business performance
- Did not clearly connect the strategy with operations performance and then also impact on business performance
- Were brief and only outlined/described elements of operations management
- Some answered a different question than the one on the assessment task (eg too much focus on influences or focus on business success/competitive advantage)
- Made outlandish claims or asserted statistics that didn't make sense.